

CIRQLSPHERE — The Lore Bible

*A living mythology for the whole CIRQLSPHERE. Draft 1 — for the owner to react to, edit, and veto. Everything here is written to slot onto what the game already whispers: light passed hand to hand, blight as "forgotten light," a greying force (BLANDCO), sparqs, Renown, the concentric shores. Names in **bold** are proposed; strike any that don't feel right.*

The one-line premise

******The CIRQLSPHERE is a world made of light and remembered into being — a sea of concentric shores, each a circle of colour cast outward from the First Spark. It is slowly being *forgotten* by a grey, flattening force. You are a light-bearer, and the world brightens by the circles you relight, the wonders you rekindle, and the tales you carry home.******

Wonder vs. the Grey. Colour vs. sameness. Memory vs. forgetting. That is the whole spine.

The Creation Myth — *The Kindling*

Before the SPHERE there was only the **Hum** — a low, lightless tone in the dark, the sound a thing makes just before it decides to exist.

Into the Hum fell the **First Spark**: one mote of living light, no larger than a firefly, warm to the touch. It did not want to be alone. So it did the only thing light knows how to do — it *reached*. Where it reached, a circle bloomed: a shore of colour ringing the spark like a ripple on still water. And because a circle, once drawn, wants a wider circle around it, the light reached again, and again — ring within ring within ring — until the dark was full of shining shores.

That nested sea of circles is the **CIRQLSPHERE**: not a ball, but the sum of every circle the First Light ever cast. The innermost shore, closest to the First Spark, is the calmest and youngest. The farther out you sail, the older, stranger, and more thinly-lit the world becomes — the ripples growing faint at the edge of the reach.

The light could not hold every circle alight by itself. So from the First Spark it shed six sparks of its own — the **Circle of Makers** — and gave each a piece of the work.

Codex hook: the First Spark is why *sparqs* are the world's currency. A sparq is not "money." It is a mote of the First Light itself — the literal raw stuff of creation, passed hand to hand. Spending one is giving a piece of the world's beginning to someone else. (This reframes every reward in the game as *sharing light*.)

The Circle of Makers

Six makers, each an aspect of wonder. They shaped the shores, then — in the event called **the Scattering** — receded into the world they'd made, leaving fragments of themselves behind. Every biome carries the fingerprint of the maker who tended it. Finding those fingerprints is the lore hunt.

- **Lumen, the Light-Tender** — kindling, lanterns, the dawn. Domain: the guiding light itself. Her fragments are lanterns that never quite went out. *(In-game: the Lantern Path, every kindle quest, the beacon hubs.)*
- **Chroma, the Colour-Weaver** — hue, bloom, the dye in a flower and the blush in a shell. Domain: everything that isn't grey. The Grey hates her most. *(In-game: flora, the Style Studio, biome palettes, the boutique.)*
- **Cadence, the Song-Keeper** — music, rhythm, the sound a place makes. Domain: the world's soundtrack, the festival, the dance. *(In-game: the adaptive score, Lio the bard, the Commons Festival, the Welcome Dance.)*
- **Verdant, the Green Hand** — growth, tending, the patience of roots. Domain: living things and their slow return. *(In-game: Garden & Grove, pets, restoration/ecology quests, the wilting meadow that can be healed.)*
- **Mirth, the Play-Bringer** — joy, games, the delight of doing a thing for no reason but fun. Domain: play. *(In-game: CirqlCade / the whole arcade, the Fair, the rides — "wonder for its own sake.")*
- **Mnemos, the Memory-Keeper** — story, lore, the tale a place refuses to forget. Domain: memory. She is the one who taught the world to record itself. *(In-game: the codex, the Oracle NPC, runestones, murals, the Lost Cartographer.)*

Cirqla — the guide who greets every new arrival at CIRQLSPACE — is not a Maker. She is a **Kindled**: a small light the Makers lit to be a first friend to newcomers, so no one arrives in the dark alone. (This gives her a quiet, lovely weight: she is proof the Makers cared how you'd *feel* on your first day.)

The Grey — *The Unlight*

Wonder has an opposite, and it is not darkness. Darkness is only unlit; it can be kindled. The true enemy is **the Grey** — also called **the Unlight**, **the Long Dimming**, or, in the old tongue, **the Bland**.

The Grey does not destroy. It *flattens*. It drains colour to sameness, turns song to hum, turns a remembered place into a place no one can quite recall. Where it passes, the ground greys, the lanterns "forget" how to burn, and travellers wander lost. **Blight is not rot — it is forgotten light**. Return the light, and the ground remembers how to bloom.

BLANDCO is the Grey wearing a suit. In the age of the Now, the Unlight learned to organise. It incorporated. It built grey towers and grey rules and a grey promise that everything would be *easier* if it were all the same. BLANDCO's grip is heaviest in **Cirql City**, the shore where the Grey nearly won — which is why the City must be walked, district by district, and its blandness pushed back door by door.

The Grey's small servants are the everyday troubles you already meet:

- **False lights** — stolen or moved lanterns that lead travellers astray (the marsh-sprite of *The False Light* was not evil; it was *lonely*, and the Grey preys on loneliness).
- **The Fog** between shores — the Grey's breath, thinning only as a shore is re-lit.
- **Greyed grounds** — blight, forgotten light, waiting to be returned.

The moral spine (important for tone): the Grey is beaten by *warmth*, not violence. You don't kill the Unlight; you out-remember it, out-colour it, out-sing it. Most "villains" turn out to be lonely, forgetful, or afraid — and the light-bearer's real weapon is attention. This keeps the whole SPHERE kind, safe for young players, and quietly profound.

Geography of the SPHERE

The world is read from the First Spark outward:

- ****CIRQLSPACE (Ring 0) — *Your Spark***** A blank, dark shore that is *yours*. You light it, build it, plant it, name it. Lore-wise: when a new light-bearer arrives, the SPHERE gifts them an unlit circle of their own, so they learn light by making some. (This is why CIRQLSPACE ships empty and everything is player-placed.)
 - ****The Town (Ring 1) — *First-Lit*. **The oldest re-kindled shore, tended since the Scattering. Home of Ferra the Light-Tender's line, Marin the cartographer, Lio the song-keeper's echo. The CirqlCade door here is a shard of Mirth's domain; the Town Hall****** keeps the shore's memory; the shops are the Makers' crafts kept alive by hand.
 - ****The Wild Shores (Rings 2+) — *The Reach***** Each a biome-realm bearing one Maker's strong fingerprint, growing older and stranger the farther out you sail. Woodland, ember, winter, aurora, coast, tropical, meadow, desert, autumn, marsh, savanna, canyon — twelve moods of light, cycling outward forever.
 - ****The Sub-Realms — *Beneath, Above, Between*. **The Undervault (caves, where old light pooled), the High Canopy (treetops, closer to the sky's light), the Cloud Reach****** (above the fog, where the Grey cannot climb).
 - **The other games, one cosmology.** The CIRQLSPHERE is the umbrella over everything: **CirqlCade / the arcade** is Mirth's playhouse; **CIRQLVERSE** (this ring-world) is the sea of shores itself; **Cirql City** is the front line against BLANDCO; **CirqlBreak** is the oldest story of all — *the night the light shattered into a thousand pieces you must gather back*, retold as a game. They are not separate products; they are **facets of one SPHERE**.
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The Ages — a timeline

A light-bearer's Oracle can place any tale on this spine:

1. **The Kindling.** The First Spark reaches; the circles bloom; the Makers are shed.
 2. **The Age of Circles.** The Makers walk the shores openly. Colour, song, growth, and play at their height. Wonders are built (the Great Tree, the Stone Circle, the Lighthouse, the Great Crystal — the landmarks you still visit).
 3. **The Scattering.** The Makers recede into the world, leaving fragments. No one is sure why — the kindest tale says a world must eventually *hold its own light*, and the Makers stepped back so their children could learn to.
 4. **The Long Dimming.** The Grey rises in the makers' absence. Shores are forgotten. The Fog thickens. Some circles go fully dark and are lost to the map. This is the age BLANDCO calls its "founding."
 5. ****The Now — *The Rekindling***** New light-bearers (the players) arrive. The world begins, shore by shore, to *remember itself*. This is where every quest, festival, pet, and wonder lives: small acts of re-lighting that add up.
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The Player as Light-Bearer — mechanics as lore

Nothing in the game is "just a mechanic." Each has a place in the myth:

Game system	What it is, in the SPHERE
Sparqs	motes of the First Light; sharing them shares creation
Renown	how brightly the SPHERE <i>remembers</i> you — a light-bearer's warmth made visible
World Energy	the shore's collective light, fed by everyone at once
Lighting lanterns	returning Lumen's kindling to a forgotten path
Quests	small re-memberings; each one un-forgets a piece of the world
Healing blight	returning forgotten light to greyed ground
The Fog / sailing	pushing through the Grey's breath to a farther, older shore
Festivals & the Welcome Dance	Cadence's communal light — many warmths at once
Pets (tamed/kindled)	small lights that choose to walk beside you
Rides & the Fair	Mirth's wonder, reawakening for its own sake
The Codex / your journal	Mnemos's gift: the world recording itself <i>through you</i>

This table is the single most useful thing in this doc: it lets the Oracle answer *any* "why does X exist?" question in-character, and it turns every existing feature into lore for free.

The Oracle — the helper who is also the lore's voice

Who: an NPC in the Town — proposed name **Mnem** (a small, kindly Kindled who carries a shard of Mnemos's memory), or keep it plainer as **"the Archivist"** / **"the Keeper of Tales."** They tend a little lantern-lit reading nook (a natural fit once interiors ship — the Library/archive room).

What they do (one NPC, two voices):

- Ask *"how do I...?"* → they answer plainly and helpfully (how-tos, walkthroughs, where to find things). The fiction bends politely: "Even an old memory can give directions."
- Ask *about the world* → they answer **in character**, drawing on the myth above, and — crucially — **read your codex**: they know what you've already discovered and give the *next* clue, not a spoiler. "You've found the Ash-Speaker's stone and the fallen star. Notice they both speak of light *passed on*? There's a third such tale, out on the frost..."

The tie to gameplay: the Oracle turns collected lore into **clues** — pointing you toward a mini-game, a hidden curio, a campaign step, or a reward, based on the fragments you hold. Lore stops being flavour text and becomes a *navigation system for wonder*.

Lore woven through the shores

Every biome holds one Maker's fingerprint and one tale-fragment. Collect enough fragments of a thread and a **campaign** or **reward** opens. The existing codex entries are already the seeds — here they are, placed in the myth:

- **Woodland — Verdant's first grove.** The oldest living things; the Great Tree remembers the Age of Circles. (*Seed: "A Field Guide Begun."*)
- **Ember — Lumen & the ash.** "Fire's last word is ash — and ash is where the next green begins." Light and renewal. (*Seed: "The Ash-Speaker."*)
- **Winter / Aurora — the light that hides to survive.** In the Long Dimming, some light fled to the cold and the sky where the Grey couldn't follow. (*Seed: the Great Crystal, the Cloud Reach.*)
- **Coast — Cadence & the tide's rhythm; the Lighthouse as Lumen's steadiest lantern.**
- **Meadow / Savanna — Chroma at full bloom;** the shores the Grey most wants to flatten.
- **Desert / Canyon — the Lost Cartographer.** "Someone charted these shards before you — and never sailed home." A light-bearer of an earlier age whose maps you keep finding. A whole mystery thread. (*Seed: "The Lost Cartographer," "A Rush Through the Canyon."*)
- **Marsh — the lonely lights.** Where the Grey preys on loneliness (the False Light). Verdant's bioluminescent bog, half-remembered. (*Seed: "The False Light."*)
- **The falling stars — Lumen's law of light.** "They fall to be carried. Light passed hand to hand is how the dark is answered." The thesis of the whole SPHERE, hidden in a ring-2 curio. (*Seed: "Why Stars Fall."*)

Mystery threads (assemble fragments → unlock): *The Lost Cartographer* (who were the light-bearers before us?), *The Scattering* (why did the Makers leave?), *The Founding of BLANDCO* (how the Grey learned to wear a suit — the Cirql City thread), *The First Spark* (the endgame lore: what lit the very first light?).

Tone & style guide

- **Warm, mythic, hopeful — with a thread of melancholy-wonder.** The kind of lore that makes a ten-year-old feel the world is bigger than the screen, and makes an adult a little wistful.
 - **Light / colour / song / memory** are the recurring images. Grey / hum / forgetting are the shadows.
 - **Kindness is the mechanic.** No gore, no cruelty; "villains" are lonely, forgetful, or afraid. The light-bearer wins by *paying attention*.
 - **Short and legible.** Codex entries are 1–3 sentences. Depth comes from *accumulation*, not wall-of-text. Nerds love the *connections*, not the essays.
 - **Never contradict the mechanics.** The lore table above is canon; new tales must fit it.
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How this seeds the game (next steps, once you bless the myth)

1. **Codex/journal UI** — a readable "Light-Bearer's Journal" grouping found fragments by thread, showing which threads are near-complete (the recording half already exists in code).
2. **Seed fragments** — attach codex entries + curios + NPC tales to each biome per the map above (much is already placed; we deepen + connect it).
3. **The Oracle NPC** — the one-NPC helper + in-character lore voice that reads your codex and gives the *next* clue.
4. **Thread rewards** — completing a mystery thread opens a campaign, a cosmetic, or a hidden shore (ties lore → rewards → quests, as you asked).
5. **Keep it umbrella-wide** — the arcade, Cirql City, and CirqlBreak all get one or two lore lines that place them in the SPHERE, so the whole brand feels like one world.

React freely: rename the Makers, swap the villain's shape, change the tone, cut whole sections. This is a starting fire, not a finished one.